



Academic Appointments

Columbia University

Department of Computer Science

Assistant Professor

2025 - Present

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

Postdoctoral Associate

2024 - 2025

Education

University of Toronto

PhD in Computer Science | *Supervised by Prof. Alec Jacobson*

2019 - 2024

University of Oviedo

BSc in Mathematics and BSc in Physics

2014 - 2019

Awards

SGP Software Award: Gpytoolbox

Eurographics Symposium on Geometry Processing (with: Prof. Oded Stein) | 1,000 EUR

2025

Alain Fournier Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation Award

Canadian Human-Computer Communications Society | 3,000 CAD

2025

Eurographics PhD Thesis Award

Eurographics | *London, United Kingdom*

2025

MIT Postdoctoral Fellowship for Engineering Excellence

MIT School of Engineering | 75,000 USD

2024-2025

DiDi Graduate Student Award in Computer Science

University of Toronto Department of Computer Science | 10,000 CAD

2024

Vanier Canada Doctoral Scholarship

Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada (NSERC) | 150,000 CAD

2021-2024

Awarded to 166 graduate students across all of Canada and all academic disciplines.

Connaught International Scholarship for Doctoral Students

University of Toronto School of Graduate Studies | 50,000 CAD

2019 - 2024

EECS Rising Stars

Academic Career Workshop in EECS | *Travel Funding*

2023

HLF Ernst Abbe Grant

Heidelberg Laureate Forum | *Travel Funding*

2023

Beatrice "Trixie" Worsley Graduate Scholarship in Computer Science

University of Toronto Department of Computer Science | 8,000 CAD

2021, 2023

Awarded to a student who has taken an active role in promoting women in Computer Science.

Adobe PhD Fellowship

Adobe Inc. | 10,000 USD

2022

Dean's Doctoral Excellence Scholarship

University of Toronto Faculty of Arts & Science | 25,000 CAD

2021

Awarded to a single doctoral student across all the University of Toronto Faculty of Arts & Science disciplines.

Adobe Research Fellowship

Adobe Inc. | *Honorable mention*

2020 - 2021

50th Anniversary Graduate Scholarship

University of Toronto Department of Computer Science | 2,000 CAD

2020

Graduate Program Award University of Toronto Department of Computer Science 10,000 CAD	2019 - 2020
Recognition of Excellence Award University of Toronto Department of Computer Science 10,000 CAD	2019 - 2019
Adobe Women in Technology Scholarship Adobe Inc. <i>Honorable Mention</i>	2019
SenseTime Fellowship MIT <i>Granted but declined</i>	2019
Scholarship for Academic Excellence María Cristina Masaveu Peterson Foundation 50,000 EUR	2014 - 2019

Research Funding

Supported Research Project Columbia-Dream Sports AI Innovation Center 99,471 USD <i>Co-PI: Prof. Steven Feiner</i>	2025-2026
Interdisciplinary Research Seed Funding (SIRS) Columbia Fu Foundation School of Engineering 85,000 USD <i>Co-PI: Prof. Hod Lipson</i>	2025-2026
Research Support nTop <i>Donation</i>	2024
Research Support Adobe <i>Donation</i>	2025

Publications

Stochastic Poisson Surface Reconstruction with One Solve using Geometric Gaussian Processes Sidhanth Holalkere, David Bindel, Silvia Sellán , Alexander Terenin <i>ICML 2025</i>	
Variational Elastodynamic Simulation Leticia Mattos Da Silva, Silvia Sellán , Natalia Pacheco-Tallaj, Justin Solomon <i>SIGGRAPH 2025</i>	
Mesh Simplification for Unfolding Manas Bhargava, Camille Schreck, Marco Freire, Pierre-Alexandre Hugron, Sylvain Lefebvre, Silvia Sellán* , Bernd Bickel* (*joint last authors) <i>Computer Graphics Forum (to be presented at Eurographics 2025)</i>	
Mirror Bridges Between Probability Measures Leticia Mattos Da Silva, Silvia Sellán , Justin Solomon <i>Under Peer Review</i>	
Surface-Filling Curve Flows via Implicit Medial Axes Yuta Noma, Silvia Sellán , Nicholas Sharp, Karan Singh, Alec Jacobson <i>SIGGRAPH 2024</i>	
Reach for the Arcs: Reconstructing Surfaces from SDFs via Tangent Points Silvia Sellán , Yingying Ren, Christopher Batty, Oded Stein <i>SIGGRAPH 2024</i>	
Bayes' Rays: Uncertainty Quantification for Neural Radiance Fields Lily Goli, Cody Reading, Silvia Sellán , Alec Jacobson, Andrea Tagliasacchi <i>CVPR 2024 (Highlight)</i>	
Reach for the Spheres: Tangency-Aware Surface Reconstruction of SDFs Silvia Sellán , Christopher Batty, Oded Stein <i>SIGGRAPH Asia 2023</i>	
Neural Stochastic Screened Poisson Reconstruction Silvia Sellán , Alec Jacobson <i>SIGGRAPH Asia 2023</i>	

Constructive Solid Geometry on Neural Signed Distance Fields

Zoë Marschner, **Silvia Sellán**, Hsueh-Ti Derek Liu, Alec Jacobson

SIGGRAPH Asia 2023

Stochastic Poisson Surface Reconstruction

Silvia Sellán, Alec Jacobson

SIGGRAPH Asia 2022

Breaking Bad: A Dataset for Geometric Fracture and Reassembly

Silvia Sellán*, Yun-Chun Chen*, Ziyi Wu*, Animesh Garg, Alec Jacobson (*joint first authors)

NeurIPS 2022 (Spotlight)

Breaking Good: Fracture Modes for Realtime Destruction

Silvia Sellán, Jack Luong, Leticia Mattos Da Silva, Aravind Ramakrishnan, Yuchuan Yang, Alec Jacobson

SIGGRAPH Asia 2022

Sex and Gender in the Computer Graphics Research Literature

Ana Dodik*, **Silvia Sellán***, Amanda Phillips, Theodore Kim

SIGGRAPH Talk 2022

Swept Volumes via Spacetime Numerical Continuation

Silvia Sellán, Noam Aigerman, Alec Jacobson

SIGGRAPH 2021

Opening and Closing Surfaces

Silvia Sellán, Jacob Kesten, Yan Sheng Ang, Alec Jacobson

SIGGRAPH Asia 2020

Developability of Heightfields via Rank Minimization

Silvia Sellán, Noam Aigerman, Alec Jacobson

SIGGRAPH 2020

Solid Geometry Processing on Deconstructed Domains

Silvia Sellán, Herng Yi Cheng, Yuming Ma, Mitchell Dembowski, Alec Jacobson

ACM / Eurographics Symposium on Geometry Processing 2019

Patents

Swept Volume Determination Techniques

Silvia Sellán, Noam Aigerman, Alec Jacobson

United States Patent No. 11810255, 2023

Generating Developable Depth Images Using Rank Minimization

Silvia Sellán, Noam Aigerman, Alec Jacobson

United States Patent No. 11080819, 2021

Software

Gpytoolbox: A Python geometry processing toolbox

Silvia Sellán, Oded Stein

A library of general geometry processing Python research utility functions, including basic procedural meshes, differential geometric operators, bounding volume hierarchies and surface reconstruction from point clouds and SDFs.

Other Publications

Task-Aware 3D Geometric Synthesis

Silvia Sellán

PhD Thesis supervised by Prof. Alec Jacobson

Geometry Synthesis for Critical Applications

Silvia Sellán

SIGGRAPH Asia Doctoral Consortium, 2023

Efficient and Robust Swept Volumes

Silvia Sellán, Noam Aigerman, Alec Jacobson

Vector Institute Research Symposium poster, 2021

Applications of Geometry Processing to Computer Graphics

Silvia Sellán

B.Sc. in Mathematics thesis co-supervised by Profs. Alec Jacobson and Carlos Fernández García

An Introduction to Primal Inflation

Silvia Sellán

B.Sc. in Physics thesis supervised by Prof. Luigi Toffolatti

Solid Geometry Processing on Deconstructed Domains

Silvia Sellán, Herng Yi Cheng, Yuming Ma, Mitchell Dembowski, Alec Jacobson

ACM / Eurographics SGP Poster, 2018

Other Research Experience

Yale University

Research Consultant | *Supervised by Prof. Theodore Kim*

Winter 2022

Adobe Research

Research Intern | *Mentored by Dr. Noam Aigerman and Supervised by Dr. Jovan Popovic*

Summer 2020

Adobe Research

Research Intern | *Mentored by Dr. Noam Aigerman and Supervised by Dr. Jovan Popovic*

Summer 2019

Fields Institute for Research in the Mathematical Sciences

Undergraduate Research Intern | *Supervised by Prof. Alec Jacobson*

Summer 2018

Fields Institute for Research in the Mathematical Sciences

Undergraduate Research Intern | *Supervised by Prof. Alec Jacobson*

Summer 2017

ICMAT (Institute of Mathematical Sciences)

Grant Programme Severo Ochoa - Introduction to Research | *Supervised by Prof. Javier Parcet*

Summer 2017

Academic Service

Austrian Science Fund

External grant reviewer

2025

Women in Graphics Rising Stars Program

Selection Committee

2025

ACM SIGGRAPH

Technical Papers Committee Member

2025

International Conference on Geometric Modeling and Processing

International Program Committee Member

2025

Graphics Replicability Stamp Initiative

International Evaluation Committee Member

2024 - Present

ACM SIGGRAPH Nominations Committee

Invited Member

2025

ACM / Eurographics Symposium on Geometry Processing (SGP)

Technical Program Chair

2025

Eurographics

International Program Committee Member

2025, 2026

ACM / Eurographics Symposium on Geometry Processing (SGP)

International Program Committee Member

2024

Summer Geometry Initiative

Steering Committee Member

2023 - Present

ACM / Eurographics Symposium on Geometry Processing (SGP) Graduate School Chair	2024
ACM SIGGRAPH Women in Graphics Research Community Group Executive Committee Member	2022 - 2023
SIGGRAPH Research Career Development Committee Committee Member (in Undergraduate Mentorship Subcommittee)	2021 - 2023
ACM / Eurographics Symposium on Geometry Processing (SGP) Session Chair: Representation and Learning	2023
ACM / Eurographics Symposium on Geometry Processing (SGP) International Program Committee Member	2023
CVPR Deep Learning for Geometric Computing Organizing Committee Member	2023
Women in Computer Graphics Research (WiGRAPH) Executive Committee Member	2020 - 2022
CVPR Deep Learning for Geometric Computing Organizing Committee Member	2022
ICCV Deep Learning for Geometric Computing Program Committee Member	2021

Referee Service

NeurIPS	2025
Pacific Graphics	2024
IEEE Transactions on Image Processing	2024
Journal of Cultural Heritage	2024
ACM SIGGRAPH Asia Technical Papers	2023 - Present
ACM / Eurographics Symposium on Geometry Processing (SGP)	2023 - 2024
ACM SIGGRAPH Technical Papers	2022 - Present
Eurographics Technical Papers	2021 - 2024
ACM Transactions on Graphics (ToG)	2021 - Present
IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence	2023
The Visual Computer (TVCJ)	2023
CVPR DLGC Technical Papers	2022-2024
International Symposium on Robotics Research	2022
Computer Aided Design Journal (CAD-J)	2022, 2024
ACM SIGGRAPH Posters	2021 - 2024
ICCV DLGC Technical Papers	2021
Journal of Computer Graphics Techniques (JCGT)	2021

Departmental Service

Faculty of Arts and Science Graduate Diversity Working Group Invited Member	2022
Dean's Advisory Search Committee - Department Chair, Computer Science Invited Member	2021 - 2022
DGP Working Group on Fostering a Safe and Inclusive Workplace Member	2021 - 2022
DCS Grad program talk for Ukranian undergraduate visiting students Panelist	2022

Graduate Applications Triager

2021

16 hours of paid work on processing graduate school applications

Talks

Geometric Processing with Signed Distance Functions

nTop | *Invited Talk*

SIGMA Workshop | *Invited Talk*

New York City (United States) | *October 2024*

CIRM Marseille (France) | *October 2024*

Stochastic Computer Graphics

University of Waterloo Computer Science Seminar | *hosted by Prof. Craig Kaplan*

University of Victoria Computer Science Seminar | *hosted by Prof. Teseo Schneider*

Max Planck Institute for Informatics Seminar | *hosted by Prof. Christopher Theobalt*

Johns Hopkins University Computer Science Seminar | *hosted by Prof. Misha Kazhdan*

Institute of Science and Technology Austria | *hosted by Prof. Chris Wojtan*

Caltech Computer Science Seminar | *hosted by Prof. Aaron Ames*

Brown University Computer Science Seminar | *hosted by Prof. Daniel Ritchie*

Columbia University Computer Science Seminar | *hosted by Prof. Changxi Zheng*

MIT Computer Science Seminar | *hosted by Prof. William Freeman*

Princeton University Computer Science Seminar | *hosted by Prof. Adam Finkelstein*

CMU Computer Science Seminar | *hosted by Prof. Keenan Crane*

UMass Amherst Machine Learning and Friends Lunch | *Invited Talk*

Waterloo (Canada) | *January 2024*

Victoria (Canada) | *February 2024*

Saarbrücken (Germany) | *February 2024*

Baltimore (United States) | *February 2024*

Vienna (Austria) | *February 2024*

Pasadena (United States) | *March 2024*

Providence (United States) | *March 2024*

New York City (United States) | *March 2024*

Cambridge (United States) | *March 2024*

Princeton (United States) | *March 2024*

Pittsburgh (United States) | *March 2024*

Virtual | *October 2024*

Uncertainty Quantification in 3D Geometric Synthesis

University of Zaragoza Graphics and Imaging seminar | *hosted by Prof. Ana Serrano*

Brown University Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Daniel Ritchie*

Banff International Research Station 3D Generative Modeling Workshop | *Invited talk*

Virtual | *November 2023*

Virtual | *October 2023*

Banff (Canada) | *July 2023*

Geometry +: Uncertain Surface Reconstruction

École polytechnique Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Maks Ovsjanikov*

INRIA seminar | *hosted by Profs. Bruno Lévy and Sylvain Lefebvre*

CNRS seminar | *hosted by Dr. Julie Digne*

University of Navarra Graphics and Vision seminar | *hosted by Prof. Asier Marzo*

University of Edinburgh Geometry seminar | *hosted by Prof. Amir Vaxman*

Adobe Research seminar | *hosted by Dr. Valentin Deschaintre*

University College London Vision seminar | *hosted by Prof. Kaan Akşit*

University of British Columbia Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Alla Sheffer*

Simon Fraser University Vision seminar | *hosted by Prof. Andrea Tagliasacchi*

EPFL Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Mark Pauly*

ETH Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Olga Sorkine-Hornung*

University of Waterloo Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Craig Kaplan*

University of Montreal Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Mikhail Bessmeltsev*

Johns Hopkins Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Misha Kazhdan*

Columbia University Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Changxi Zheng*

New York University Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Daniele Panozzo*

MIT Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Justin Solomon*

Dartmouth Graphics and Rendering seminar | *hosted by Prof. Wojciech Jarosz*

TomatoGRAPH | *Technical Talk*

Paris (France) | *July 2023*

Nancy (France) | *June 2023*

Lyon (France) | *June 2023*

Pamplona (Navarra) | *June 2023*

Edinburgh (Scotland) | *June 2023*

London (England) | *June 2023*

London (England) | *June 2023*

Vancouver (Canada) | *June 2023*

Vancouver (Canada) | *June 2023*

Lausanne (Switzerland) | *May 2023*

Zürich (Switzerland) | *May 2023*

Waterloo (Canada) | *April 2023*

Montréal (Québec) | *November 2022*

Baltimore (United States) | *November 2022*

New York City (United States) | *November 2022*

New York City (United States) | *November 2022*

Cambridge (United States) | *November 2022*

Hanover (United States) | *November 2022*

Toronto (Canada) | *December 2021*

Mesh Math and Beyond: An introduction to shape representations

Summer Geometry Initiative | *Full-day tutorial*

Summer Geometry Initiative | *Full-day tutorial*

Summer Geometry Initiative | *Full-day tutorial*

Virtual | *July 2023*

Virtual | *July 2022*

Virtual | *July 2021*

Blender for Academic Papers

Graphics Interface | *Invited Course*

Geometry and Architecture Summit | *Invited Talk*

ACM / Eurographics SGP | *Invited Course*

Victoria (Canada) | *June 2023*

Toronto (Canada) | *October 2022*

Virtual | *June 2022*

Geometry +: Moving Fast, Breaking Things and Putting Them Back Together

University of Southern California Graphics seminar | *hosted by Prof. Oded Stein*

Los Angeles (United States) | *April 2023*

McGill University Graphics seminar <i>hosted by Prof. Oded Stein</i>	Montréal (Québec) <i>November 2022</i>
Ubisoft research seminar <i>hosted by the LaForge team</i>	Montréal (Québec) <i>November 2022</i>
Yale University Rising Stars seminar <i>hosted by Prof. Theodore Kim</i>	New Haven (United States) <i>November 2022</i>
Engineering and Applied Science Forum <i>hosted by the EASF team</i>	Virtual <i>November 2022</i>

Uncertain Surface Reconstruction

UCLA and CalTech's Grundfest Memorial Lecture <i>hosted by Profs. Achuta Kadambi and Katie Bouman</i>	Virtual <i>March 2023</i>
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Research in Geometry Processing

University of Toronto Undergraduate Graphics Club <i>Invited Talk</i>	Toronto (Canada) <i>February 2023</i>
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Stochastic Poisson Surface Reconstruction

ACM SIGGRAPH Asia <i>Technical Paper presentation</i>	Daegu (South Korea) <i>December 2022</i>
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Breaking Good: Fracture Modes for Realtime Destruction

ACM SIGGRAPH Asia <i>Technical Paper presentation</i>	Daegu (South Korea) <i>December 2022</i>
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Breaking Bad: A Dataset for Geometric Fracture Reassembly

NeurIPS <i>Featured (oral) paper presentation</i>	New Orleans (United States) <i>November 2022</i>
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Virtual Bodies that Matter: A Trans Researcher's Career in Computer Graphics

Georgetown's Gender and Media Seminar <i>hosted by Prof. Amanda Phillips</i>	Washington, D.C. (United States) <i>November 2022</i>
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Sex and Gender in the Computer Graphics Literature

Queer in AI @ NeurIPS workshop <i>Invited Talk</i>	New Orleans (United States) <i>November 2022</i>
UNC Chapel Hill <i>hosted by Prof. Roni Sengupta</i>	New Orleans (United States) <i>November 2022</i>
ACM SIGGRAPH <i>Talk presentation</i>	Vancouver (Canada) <i>August 2022</i>

A Deep Dive into Implicit Swept Volumes

University of Toronto Undergraduate Graphics Club <i>Invited Talk</i>	Toronto (Canada) <i>March 2022</i>
INRIA MFX research seminar <i>hosted by Prof. Sylvain Lefebvre</i>	Virtual <i>June 2021</i>
MIT Graphics research seminar <i>hosted by Prof. Justin Solomon</i>	Virtual <i>June 2021</i>
GraphQUON <i>Technical presentation</i>	Virtual <i>December 2020</i>

Swept Volumes via Spacetime Numerical Continuation

ACM SIGGRAPH <i>Technical Paper presentation</i>	Virtual (originally Los Angeles) <i>August 2021</i>
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An Introduction to GP Programming in MATLAB with Gptoolbox

ACM / Eurographics SGP <i>Invited Course</i>	Virtual <i>July 2021</i>
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Developable Surfaces: A Case Study in Discrete Differential Geometry

Lancaster University Pure Mathematics Postgraduate Forum <i>Invited Talk</i>	Virtual <i>March 2021</i>
Technion research seminar <i>hosted by Prof. Mirela Ben-Chen</i>	Virtual <i>December 2020</i>
Carnegie Mellon University Geometry seminar <i>hosted by Prof. Keenan Crane</i>	Virtual <i>November 2020</i>

Seamless Integration of Virtual and Real World

Eurographics 2021 <i>Doctoral Consortium talk</i>	Virtual (originally Vienna) <i>May 2021</i>
University of Toronto <i>PhD Qualifying Exam</i>	Toronto (Canada) <i>September 2020</i>

Opening and Closing Surfaces

ACM SIGGRAPH Asia <i>Technical Paper presentation</i>	Virtual (originally Daegu) <i>December 2020</i>
Epic Games <i>hosted by Dr. Ryan Schmidt</i>	Virtual <i>November 2020</i>
Fields Institute Undergraduate Summer Research Program <i>End-of-summer research talk</i>	Toronto (Canada) <i>August 2017</i>
University of Toronto DCS Summer Research Program <i>Mid-summer research talk</i>	Toronto (Canada) <i>July 2017</i>

Developability of Heightfields via Rank Minimization

Toronto Geometry Colloquium <i>Opener talk for Prof. Olga Sorkine-Hornung</i>	Virtual <i>October 2020</i>
SIGGRAPH 2020 <i>Technical Paper presentation</i>	Virtual (originally Washington, D.C.) <i>August 2020</i>

Solid Geometry Processing on Deconstructed Domains

Stanford University Graphics seminar <i>hosted by Prof. Doug James</i>	Stanford (United States) <i>October 2019</i>
ACM / Eurographics SGP <i>Technical Paper presentation</i>	Milan (Italy) <i>July 2019</i>
Toronto-Montreal Area Graphics workshop <i>Technical talk</i>	Toronto (Canada) <i>December 2017</i>
Fields Institute Undergraduate Summer Research Program <i>End-of-summer research talk</i>	Toronto (Canada) <i>August 2017</i>

University of Toronto DCS Summer Research Program | *Mid-summer research talk*

Toronto (Canada) | *July 2017*

Applications of Geometry Processing to Computer Graphics

University of Oviedo | *B.Sc. in Mathematics Thesis Defense*

Oviedo (Spain) | *June 2019*

An Introduction to Primal Inflation

University of Oviedo | *B.Sc. in Physics Thesis Defense*

Oviedo (Spain) | *June 2019*

News

Animation technique simulates the motion of squishy objects

MIT News, written by Adam Zewe

June 2025

What Do Food and Research Have in Common? More Than You Might Think

Spektrum.de, written by Nina Beier

January 2024

Computer graphics researcher Silvia Sellán is awarded two prestigious scholarships

A&S News, written by Chris Sasaki

July 2021

Silvia Sellán on Virtual Colloquium Planning

Q&A with WiGRAPH, written by Kate Salesin

June 2021

Organizing

ACM SIGGRAPH Women in Graphics Research Community group

Undergraduate Outreach Coordinator

2023

CVPR Deep Learning for Geometric Computing Workshop

Organizing Committee Member

2023

ACM SIGGRAPH Women in Graphics Research Community group

Event Coordinator: Symposium on Geometry Processing

2022

Toronto Geometry Colloquium

Founder, organizer and art director

2020 - 2023

SIGGRAPH Graduate Applications Mentorship Program

Founder and organizer

2022

Summer Geometry Institute

Admissions committee member and session planner

2022

CVPR Deep Learning for Geometric Computing Workshop

Organizing Committee Member

2022

Women in Graphics Research

Event Coordinator: Symposium on Geometry Processing

2020 - 2021

SIGGRAPH Graduate Applications Mentorship Program

Founder and organizer

2021

Summer Geometry Institute

Admissions committee member and session planner

2021

Symposium on Geometry Processing (SGP)

Student volunteer working on tech support full time during the conference and in Spanish-language outreach

2021

Toronto-Montreal-Waterloo Graphics Workshop (TomatoGRAPH)

Student volunteer

2021

Teaching

Summer Geometry Initiative

Instructor of a full-day tutorial including lectures, coding demos and exercises

Summer 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024

Graphics Interface

Lecturer of the course Blender for Academic Papers

Summer 2023

Symposium on Geometry Processing (SGP)

Lecturer of the SGP course Blender for Academic Papers

Summer 2022

Symposium on Geometry Processing (SGP)

Co-lecturer of the SGP course An introduction to geometry processing programming in MATLAB with gptoolbox

Summer 2021

CSC165: Mathematical Expression and Reasoning for Computer Science

Teaching Assistant (120 hours) for Prof. David Liu

Winter 2020

Individual High School Tutoring

Weekly paid mathematics and physics tutoring

2015-2018

Teaching Feedback

Summer Geometry Institute

2021

During the summer of 2021, I planned, prepared and conducted a 6-hour long tutorial session on the topic of shape representations for undergraduate students of underrepresented communities, as part of MIT's Summer Geometry Institute (SGI). A representative sample of the anonymous feedback collected by professor Justin Solomon about my teaching is reproduced below, each quotation corresponding to different student.

Silvia Sellán's presentation was idyllic, it gave the feeling of being a duck in a pond being fed delicious crumbs of bread, the students being the duck and Silvia the feeder throwing in one after another the information that we like the ducks devoured. The presentation itself was amazing to go beyond analogy it was clear and concise towards learning the topic, the information did not feel too overwhelming, nor too brief. The exercises as well as giving focus upon them and breaking them apart into which to do at what times, they felt like the perfect amount of material in order to have us learn and test our knowledge of the topics.

I just wanted to say that I really enjoyed Silvia's programme. Cutting out all the formulas definitely made her material really accessible and easy to follow without worrying about the precise details of what is going on. I think leaving these details for us to figure out by doing the exercises is really good for developing understanding, rather than having a perhaps more technical talk which is harder to follow and then not quite knowing how to approach the exercises.

Silvia's lecture was the easiest to follow and the most approachable.

Silvia's tutorial: Lively and engaging, I liked how a narrative that tied in everything together neatly was presented.

I really liked Silvia Sellán's tutorial day because for the presentations she gave us a story illustrating the motivation behind the concepts and theory and the actual coding assignments were very accessible and did not require a lot of background material.

I think a very good example of this was Silvia Sellán's tutorial day. She approached the advanced topics from a big picture perspective and all of the coding exercises needed "basic" MATLAB and knowledge of calculus and a small amount of linear algebra.

I thoroughly enjoyed Silvia's talk and the associated exercises.

I also found Silvia's talk very valuable, not only for the geometry processing material offered (which was undoubtedly great, well-structured and very accessible), but also for increasing our awareness about potential nefarious uses of geometry processing. Also the brief digressions on true diversity when talking about fonts/letters were in my opinion very welcome – I (unfortunately) tend to think in a very "westernized" way, and it's always good to bring awareness to things outside of our intellectual comfort zone.

I really liked Silvia Sellán's day of the tutorial week. I think she did a really good job of creating presentations and exercises that met me where I am as a student without a formal experience in geometry processing. The mathematics and computer science that she talked as well as exercises she designed were accessible to me as someone who has undergraduate majors in mathematics and computer science as well as had participated in larger projects with programming computer graphics components. I also think she did a really good job of telling and motivating a story, which was really important to staying engaged throughout the day. I also really appreciate that she spoke about ethics in computing and the need to think critically about academic work. It's definitely something that is not spoken enough about and that needs to be spoken about more.

YOU GUYS ARE WONDERFUL! Not gonna lie, I started looking at PhD opportunities to pursue this field after attending this program.

Mentoring

BBrian

PhD Student at Columbia University

2025 - Present

Daria Nogina

PhD Student at Columbia University

2025 - Present

Mentoring Feedback

Summer Geometry Institute

2021, 2023

During the summers of 2021 and 2023 (the latter together with my colleague Ana Dodik), I worked as a mentor for MIT's Summer Geometry Initiative, founded by Professor Justin Solomon. In it, I directed two projects for two groups of undergraduate students from underrepresented communities new to geometry processing. Below is a representative sample of the anonymous feedback collected by Prof. Solomon

Ana and Silvia built a collaborative, safe, open environment for new ideas. Both taught us a lot about how to research and approach problems with different approaches. They are outstanding researchers that I admire even more now.

Ana and Silvia are both absolutely fantastic mentors!

This week has been great! Ana and Silvia are excellent mentors. They created an excellent environment for us to learn and collaborate

I still have no idea what Silvia's role was, but she went above and beyond to help out with everything. She made us all feel welcome in the Slack channel before SGI even started and continued to dole out advice and support throughout the whole of SGI. She also patiently answered my millions of questions almost as quickly as I could ask them.

Silvia ensured we all felt welcome right from the beginning of the Slack channel. When we introduced ourselves, I noticed she found something nice to say to each of us, and it felt very welcoming to have that display of friendliness right from the get-go.

Silvia Sellán, I would like to thank you specifically for the SGP & Siggraph 2021 WiGraph event, sharing your thoughts in grad school event and being accessible.

Volunteering

General election worker

July 2023

Day-long volunteer helping citizens vote on the day of the Spanish General Elections.

Reading Partners

August 2020

Translation of documents into Spanish for literacy non-profit

General election worker

April 2019

Day-long volunteer helping citizens vote on the day of the Spanish General Elections.

General election worker

June 2016

Day-long volunteer helping citizens vote on the day of the Spanish General Elections.